

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Quality Is a Decision Variable

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C03
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Judge data fitness for the intended decision across completeness, timeliness, coverage, coherence, revisions, and drift.

Why it matters

A composite quality average can conceal a failed critical field, unlawful source, unusable delay, or severe subgroup gap.

Illustrative application

Weighted coverage reveals when a small number of missing reporting units represent a large share of the affected population.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.